# Rajat Khirid

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## Summary

DevOps engineer with 3+ years on AWS and Kubernetes; AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional. Cut AWS spend 45% ($200K/year), moved 50+ services to EKS, and built an LLM agent that fixes CI/CD failures.

## Skills

**Cloud**: AWS (EKS, ECS, EC2, Lambda, API Gateway, Step Functions, Aurora/RDS, Redshift, ElastiCache, S3, SQS, Route 53, CloudFront, ALB, VPC, PrivateLink, Transit Gateway, Graviton, Spot), Microsoft Azure
**Containers & GitOps**: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, ArgoCD, Karpenter, KEDA
**IaC & CI/CD**: Terraform, CloudFormation, Argo Workflows, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, AWS CodePipeline
**Security**: IAM, IRSA, Secrets Manager, KMS, GuardDuty, CloudTrail, AWS Config, WAF, Trivy, RBAC
**Observability & SRE**: Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, New Relic, SLO-based alerting, on-call, RCA
**AI & Scripting**: Python, Bash, Linux, LLM agents, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Claude and OpenAI APIs
**Spoken Languages**: English, French (B1), Marathi, Hindi

## Experience

**Amber** | *DevOps Engineer* Dec 2024 - Present

- Own production AWS infrastructure and internal tooling for 50+ services serving 50,000+ monthly active users; the company's only DevOps engineer for 8 of those months. Mentor engineers on Kubernetes and CI/CD.
- Ran a cost program that cut monthly AWS spend 45% ($35-38K to $19-21K, about $200K/year) in 2.5 months with no impact on availability: moved Aurora Serverless, Redis (to Valkey) and ECS Fargate onto Graviton, Redshift to RA3, fault-tolerant jobs to Spot, CI onto self-hosted runners, and 14 ALBs down to 4, cut SQS costs 90% with long polling, then added Savings Plans.
- Migrated 50+ services from ECS and EC2 to EKS with a zero-downtime blue-green cutover; run them with Helm, ArgoCD, Karpenter (Spot and On-Demand), and KEDA, tuning autoscaling to raise utilization 24%.
- Built an LLM agent in Python over MCP that reads failed builds across 30+ Jenkins and Argo Workflows pipelines, finds the root cause, and posts the fix to Slack; it opens PRs for code and config defects and retries transient ones, auto-resolving 40% of failures, cutting mean triage time 70%, and saving 8+ hours/week.
- Extended the agent to review Terraform and Helm PRs for security and cost, audit AWS and EKS for drift, and run alert-driven fixes (rollbacks, restarts, scaling, node drains) behind Slack approvals.
- Moved deploys from weekly to daily with CI/CD in Argo Workflows, Jenkins, and GitHub Actions, and codified 4 AWS accounts in Terraform modules with remote state, replacing manual provisioning.
- Secured 4 AWS accounts: least-privilege IAM with IRSA and OIDC (no long-lived keys), External Secrets, KMS on all data stores, GuardDuty, CloudTrail and Config alerts, Trivy and IaC checks gating deploys, and WAF.
- Set up Grafana, Prometheus, and CloudWatch dashboards with SLO-based alerting and on-call runbooks; customer-impacting incidents are caught by alerts within 5 minutes and closed with a blameless post-mortem.

**IAMOPS** | *DevOps Engineer* Oct 2023 - Dec 2024

- Designed and delivered Azure-to-AWS migrations on CloudFront, ECS, and RDS, saving clients $54K/year.
- Met weekly with 4 client accounts to present migration plans and solution designs, and reviewed their accounts against the Well-Architected security pillar (IAM, encryption, logging).
- Built parallel multi-environment CI/CD with Jenkins and CodePipeline, cutting environment setup from 2.5 hours to 40 minutes, and wrote modular Terraform with remote state, cutting provisioning time by over 80%.
- Built Lambda and Step Functions automation, cutting recurring AWS spend 25% and 10+ hours/week of toil.
- Covered on-call, RCAs, and runbooks, and monitored client services with CloudWatch, Grafana, and New Relic.

## Certifications

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional (SAP-C02) - Amazon Web Services Jul 2026
- Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) - Microsoft Feb 2023

## Education

**Savitribai Phule Pune University** | *B.E. Computer Science, Honors in AI* | 9.33 CGPA Jul 2020 - Jun 2023
**Sinhgad Polytechnic** | *Diploma in Computer Technology* | 90.46% Jul 2017 - Mar 2020